OUR LADY OF FATIMA UNIVERSITY
College of Pharmacy
Laboratory Automation System

PHARMALAB · STAFF GUIDE

Laboratory Material Requests: From Request to Return

How a material request moves through PharmaLab, what laboratory staff do at each step, and how inventory changes along the way.

01 **Sign in** — Student / faculty Google account
02 **Request** — Experiment kit auto-filled
03 **Review** — Approve or reject
04 **Checklist** — Print for release
05 **Release** — Stock is deducted
06 **Return** — Good items back to stock

Status: `Pending` → `Approved` → `Released` → `Returned` · or `Rejected` from Pending

1 Sign in (students and faculty)

Requesters scan the laboratory QR code or open the request form, then choose **Continue with Google**.

Who	Email accepted	Can do
Students (Valenzuela)	…val@student.fatima.edu.ph	Submit requests, see only their own requests
Faculty	@fatima.edu.ph	Same as students
Laboratory staff	Emails on the staff list	Everything in the staff pages

Other emails (e.g. gmail.com, other campuses) are refused. Students and faculty cannot open staff pages.

2 The request form (4 steps)

Step 1 · Requester info

Name comes from Google. Student number, course, year, section and group are remembered for the next request.

Step 2 · Request details

Subject by code (e.g. **PCOG221 · Pharmacognosy**), experiment (e.g. **Exp 3 · …**), **number of groups**, number of students when needed, date, time, instructor and room.

Step 3 · Items

The **experiment kit** appears automatically with totals computed for the number of groups. Requesters may **uncheck** items but cannot change quantities. Missing ingredients are requested as **"Substitute for ..."** or **Additional item**.

Step 4 · Confirm

Review and submit. A reference number is issued (e.g. `REQ-2026-1111-0123`). The request appears as Pending in the student's **My Requests**.

How kit totals are computed: per group × number of groups · per student × number of students · per class = counted once. Items without a set amount show *"as needed"*.

3 Review the request (Lab Tech page)

- Open the request to see requester details, experiment, groups and items. Items marked **Substitute for ...** or **Additional item** are labelled.
- While Pending, staff may **edit** details and items.
- **Approve**, or **Reject** with a reason. The student sees the reason in My Requests.
- Approving does **not** change inventory.

4 Print the dispensing checklist

- Folio / long bond, black and white, one page.
- Shows requester, experiment, **number of groups**, items and remarks. Substitutes are noted in the Remarks column.
- The **Returned** column is filled in when items come back.
- Signatures: **Released by** (Laboratory Technician), **Received by** (Student), and return **Verified by** (Laboratory Instructor).

5 Release the materials

Press **Release** when the materials are handed over. Status becomes Released and every item is **deducted from inventory**.

Item type	What happens
Chemicals / reagents	Deducted and consumed. They do not come back to stock.
Glassware / equipment	Deducted while borrowed. Returned to stock when they come back in good condition.

Read the warning after release. PharmaLab lists anything it could not deduct automatically: items not found in inventory, items marked "as needed", unit mismatches, or **low stock** (e.g. "only 4 pcs was in stock, requested 10"). Adjust those manually.

PharmaLab records exactly which inventory item and how much was taken, so the return puts back the right amount to the right item.

6 Process the return

Press **Process Return**. For every borrowed glassware and equipment item, enter how many came back:

Field	Meaning	Effect
Good	Returned in usable condition (pre-filled with the full amount)	Added back to inventory
Damaged	Returned broken or unusable	Logged in **Breakage / Damage**; not restocked
Missing	Calculated automatically: released − good − damaged	Logged as **missing**; not restocked

- When there is damage or a missing item, enter the **student name** and **group** for the incident log.
- Good + Damaged cannot be more than what was released; PharmaLab blocks the return until it is corrected.
- After confirming, status becomes Returned and a summary of logged incidents is shown.

Example: 10 test tubes released → Good 8, Damaged 1 → Missing 1. Inventory gets 8 back; Breakage / Damage gets 1 breakage and 1 missing entry.

7 Status reference

Status	Meaning	Inventory
Pending	Submitted, waiting for review. Staff can still edit.	No change
Approved	Approved; materials being prepared.	No change
Rejected	Not approved; reason shown to the requester.	No change
Released	Materials handed over.	All items deducted
Returned	Borrowed items checked back in. Request complete.	Good items restocked

8 Keeping experiment kits up to date

- **Settings → Experiment Kits → Import from Excel:** upload the professors' "Summary of materials" workbook. Review the preview (subject codes, items, warnings), then import. Re-importing replaces that subject's materials.
- **Edit one experiment:** choose the subject and experiment, then change quantities, units, basis (per group / per student / per class), default number of groups, or link an item to inventory. Items marked *"Not in inventory"* are requested but not deducted automatically until linked.
- **Subjects and experiments** can be hidden instead of deleted, so past requests keep their history.
- **Instructors:** link instructors to subjects in Settings → Instructors so the right names appear in the form.

9 Quick answers

Situation	What to do
A main ingredient is out of stock	The student requests a **Substitute for** that item; it appears labelled on the request and checklist.
Release warns "not found in inventory"	Deduct manually, then link the kit item to the inventory item in Settings → Experiment Kits.
Only part of the items came back	Enter the Good and Damaged counts; the rest is logged as Missing automatically.
A new lab technician needs access	Ask the system administrator to add their email to the staff list.
A student cannot sign in	Check they use their school Google account ending in `val@student.fatima.edu.ph`.
Where is the history?	**Activity Log** records releases, borrows, returns and edits. **Breakage / Damage** lists incidents.

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